
Succeeding at Speed Dating

A few minutes to feel a spark

4 psychology approaches · tips — by EvaTalk

TO BEGIN

A few minutes to feel a spark

Speed dating is a series of mini-encounters: a few minutes per person. The point isn't to know everything, but to feel whether there's a spark to explore later.

This guide helps you handle the format, ask good questions, and stay yourself despite the pace.

YOUR INTENTION

What stresses or attracts you about the speed-dating format: _____

A spark, not a verdict

In a few minutes, you don't judge a whole life: you feel an energy, a curiosity, a wish to know more. The goal is to spot people to see again, not to decide everything on the spot.

Understanding this removes the pressure of 'playing it all in 5 minutes'.

Example

Marc wanted to 'know everything' about each one; aiming just for the spark made his speed dates far more enjoyable.

My goal

What are you really trying to spot in a few minutes?

Not a verdict

Write: 'I spot a spark, I don't give a verdict.'

Takeaway — In a few minutes, you feel a spark — not a final verdict.

'I must impress in 5 minutes'

'I must be unforgettable', 'if I botch the intro it's over', 'everyone must like me': these thoughts tense you up and make you play a role.

Reframing them returns your presence and spontaneity.

Example

'I only have 5 minutes to nail it' panicked Sarah, until she saw simplicity impressed more than performance.

Spot the pressure

Note a time-pressure thought · a calmer version.

Simple and present

Write: 'Simplicity impresses more than performance.'

Takeaway — Simplicity impresses more than performance, even in 5 minutes.

Sincere curiosity

Be sincerely curious: a real question, real listening, create more connection than a polished act. Let your true reactions (and theirs) guide you.

You evaluate as much as you're evaluated: stay yourself.

Example

By asking a sincere question rather than a pickup line, Nia created real little moments of connection.

My go-to question

A sincere, light question to ask each person: _____

I evaluate too

Write: 'I feel what I feel, not just whether I'm liked.'

Takeaway — Real curiosity creates more bond than a polished act.

Read interest, and follow up

In practice: prepare 2-3 open questions, take short notes between rounds (you mix up faces fast), spot mutual interest (smiles, questions back), and quickly follow up with those who struck you.

Don't over-read 5 minutes: it's a door, not a story.

Example

By noting his favorites and following up the next day, Karim turned a speed-dating night into real dates.

My kit

Your 2-3 questions and your note system: _____

The follow-up

Write: 'I quickly follow up with those who struck me.'

Takeaway — Prepare your questions, take notes, and follow up fast.

Key takeaways

- In a few minutes, you feel a spark, not a verdict.
- Simplicity impresses more than performance.
- Real curiosity creates more bond than a polished act.
- You evaluate as much as you're evaluated.
- Prepare 2-3 questions and take short notes.
- Quickly follow up with those who struck you.

Your turn

My mindset

What I try to spot	The pressure thought

My method

My go-to question	My kit / the follow-up

YOUR JOURNEY

Your 4-week plan

Week 1

See speed dating as a spark to spot.

Week 2

Reframe 'I must impress in 5 min'.

Week 3

Bet on sincere curiosity.

Week 4

Prepare my questions, system, follow-ups.

YOUR PLAN

Your action plan

My 'I spot a spark' line:

My go-to question:

My note/follow-up system:

A few minutes are enough to feel whether to meet again.

This guide is a coaching and psychoeducation tool — not therapy. It's for everyone, whatever your gender or orientation. Respect and consent come first: if a date endangers or disrespects you, your safety comes first. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.